

Incident Alert 0024. TLP CLEAR.			Date	Breakout Scale
Title	EU – Russian Sanctioned Entities Accessible to EU Audiences on Facebook		06/08/2024	2

Summary

- As of July 31st 2024, at least 52 Facebook pages and accounts of Russian media entities and individuals sanctioned by the EU, posing as such, or consistently amplifying their content are accessible to EU audiences.
- The pages have around 3,9 million followers on Facebook.
- Since EU sanctions were enacted in March 2022, at least 10,000 posts sharing links to mirror websites of sanctioned Russian media were made across four European languages.
- [Council Regulation No. 269/2014](#) prohibits hosting content from these channels or making them available to EU audiences on video-sharing platforms, as clarified in [Commission guidance](#) updated mid-May 2024.

Incident

On Facebook, some official accounts of sanctioned media and individuals are accessible to EU audiences. In addition, other accounts that have repeatedly or exclusively posted content from sanctioned entities also remain accessible. These accounts include:

- Eight sanctioned media entities' official accounts, most of which are labeled by Facebook as controlled by the Russian government,
- 10 personal accounts of personalities specifically sanctioned by the EU (see Annex I of Council Regulation No. 269/2014), including several with a large following,
- Three official accounts of shows from sanctioned media, with some hosting entire show episodes on the platform,
- Four accounts belonging to journalists or hosts of shows broadcast on sanctioned media entities, frequently posting content from sanctioned entities,
- 13 amplifier accounts with all the hallmarks of sanctioned media (name, logo, only posting content produced by the entity),
- 14 amplifier accounts that repeatedly post content produced by sanctioned entities but which do not appear to be directly affiliated with them.

Furthermore, we discovered that links to mirror websites of sanctioned media appeared in Facebook posts approximately 10,000 times across four European languages since EU sanctions were enacted in March 2022. Ten pages or groups have each shared these mirror URLs more than 95 times since the sanctions were imposed in March 2022.

Narrative

N/A

Impact

Reach: The identified accounts have around 3,9 million followers (the EU share of which cannot be inferred from public data).

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Facilitate State Propaganda](#) – Spread Russian operational content via Facebook.
[Conceal Network Identity](#) - Individuals hiding their affiliation to the Russian state.

Recommendations

- Action taken: Case reported to Meta (05/08/2024), European Institutions, and EU member states.
- Meta should: sweep Facebook to automatically identify videos containing the logos of the sanctioned media and systematically go through the list of sanctioned entities and ensure their accounts are not accessible in the EU.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Content type	Platforms
Link	Sanctions, Russia	Link	Charles Terroille , Science Feedback Saman Nazari , A4E	Video, image, Facebook text.	